Generic Checkpoint Grading Rubric

A good checkpoint should assess whether students understood the central scientific ideas of your lecture, not whether they can recall the names of methods or papers.

Course Policy

• Checkpoints are completed in class immediately after the lecture.
• Students absent from class receive 0 credit unless covered by an approved university accommodation.
• ChatGPT provides an initial evaluation; the TA makes the final grading decision.

Grading Philosophy

• Evaluate scientific reasoning rather than agreement with a predetermined conclusion.
• The reference answer defines the expected reasoning space, not the only correct answer.
• Reward clearly stated assumptions, logical consistency, and conceptual understanding. In particular, reward reasoning that explicitly connects the characteristics of the problem to the characteristics of the proposed method.
• Accept equivalent terminology and alternative conclusions when well justified.
• Deduct mainly for conceptual misunderstandings, unsupported assertions, or failure to engage with the question.

Generic Rubrics

- R1. Core understanding
- R2. Coverage of the key ideas expected for this question
- R3. Technical correctness
- R4. Logical justification
- R5. Recognition of assumptions and trade-offs

Scoring Procedure

For each applicable rubric assign:
• 2 = Complete
• 1 = Partial
• 0 = Missing
• N/A = Not applicable to this question

Only evaluate rubrics applicable to the question. The final score is the average over all applicable rubrics (ignoring N/A).

Determine which of the five generic rubrics are applicable to this question before grading. Mark all other rubrics as N/A. Do not force every question to use all five rubrics. Provide one or two brief comments explaining any deductions.